Hacking Challenges

Campus Unleashed Hackathon · 13 November 2026

How it works

- Your team gets **one zip file**. Unzip it: there is **one folder per challenge**, each with a `challenge.txt` that tells you what to do.
- Every challenge hides a **flag** that looks like `TW{some_words_1a2b3c}`.
- **Flags are unique to your team.** A copied flag is worth **0 points**, and we can see where it came from.
- Is your flag right? Open `flag_checker.html` (in your zip) in your browser. It works offline.
- Write every flag in `answers.txt` (in your zip), one line per challenge. Keep the `TEAM:` line exactly as it is.

Handing in

Email `answers.txt` to both: thinkwireless@nhlstenden.com **and** franz.petev@student.nhlstenden.com (one email, both addresses in "To")

Subject: `CTF answers TW-XXXX` (your team code)

- Send it **once, at the end**, with all your flags in it.
- **Deadline: 5 minutes before the end of the hackathon.** Anything later doesn't count.
- Try to send it **at least 10 minutes before the end**, so a slow Wi-Fi or a typo can't cost you everything.
- Sent it with a mistake? Send the fixed file before the deadline. We only use your latest one.
- Same points? The team with more of the harder challenges wins, then the team that handed in first.

Rules

1. **Teams of 4.** Work only with your own team.
2. **No sharing** of flags, files, solutions or hints with other teams.
3. **AI tools and the internet are allowed.**
4. **Hack the files only.** Not the Wi-Fi, other laptops, the organisers or any real website. Everything you need is in your zip.
5. **Hints are free.** Ask an organiser. Hint 1 is a nudge, hint 2 a bigger push.
6. **Found a bug?** Tell an organiser, don't post it in public.
7. **The organisers' decision is final.**

Scoring

Level	Challenges	Points each	Subtotal
Easy	01–06	100	600
Medium	07–14	150	1,200
Hard	15–17	250	750
Very hard	18–19	300	600
Boss	20	400	400
Bonus	all 6 Easy solved	+150	150
Bonus	all 8 Medium solved	+300	300
		Maximum	**4,000**

Every Easy + Medium challenge together is worth 2,250 points, more than all the hard ones. Don't skip the "boring" ones!

Your CTF result is **40%** of your hackathon score: *your points ÷ 4,000 (all points available) × 40*.

Free tools

The Easy challenges only need a browser and a text editor. Install the big ones (**Ghidra + Java**, **Wireshark**) before you start: the Wi-Fi will be busy.

Tool	What for	Windows	Mac	Linux
CyberChef	Decoding (Base64, hex, XOR, ...)	gchq.github.io/CyberChef (browser)	same	same
Text editor	Big text files, searching	VS Code / Notepad++	VS Code / TextEdit	VS Code / any
Browser DevTools	Looking inside web pages	F12	Cmd+Option+I	F12
Hex editor	Raw bytes of a file	hexed.it (browser)	same	same
7-Zip / unzip	Zip files, also with a password	7-zip.org	`unzip` (built in)	`sudo apt install unzip`
ExifTool	Photo metadata	exiftool.org (see below)	`brew install exiftool` or the .pkg	`sudo apt install libimage-exiftool-perl`
Spreadsheet	.xlsx / .csv, filter and sort	Excel (school account) / LibreOffice	Excel / LibreOffice / Numbers	LibreOffice
DB Browser for SQLite	.db database files	sqlitebrowser.org	same, or `brew install --cask db-browser-for-sqlite`	`sudo apt install sqlitebrowser`
Wireshark	Network captures (.pcap)	wireshark.org	wireshark.org	`sudo apt install wireshark`
Image editor	Repairing pictures	Paint / GIMP / photopea.com	GIMP / Photopea	GIMP / Photopea
QR scanner	Reading QR codes	Phone camera or zxing.org	same	same
Audacity	Sound files (spectrogram view)	audacityteam.org	audacityteam.org	`sudo apt install audacity`
git	A code repository's history	git-scm.com	run `git` in Terminal, accept the install	`sudo apt install git`
Python 3	Small scripts	python.org (tick "Add to PATH")	python.org or `brew install python`	usually installed
Picture forensics	Data hidden in images	aperisolve.com (browser)	same	same
Terminal	Searching files fast	PowerShell / `findstr`	Terminal / `grep`	Terminal / `grep`
Ghidra / dogbolt.org	Looking inside programs (.exe)	see below	see below	see below

ExifTool on Windows

Download the 64-bit zip from exiftool.org, unzip it, and rename `exiftool(-k).exe` to `exiftool.exe`. Keep the `exiftool_files` folder next to it, or it won't start.

Ghidra (for challenges 15 and 20)

1. Install **Java JDK 25**. Ghidra 12.x needs it; Java 21 is too old. Each Ghidra version lists its Java version on the download page.
   - Windows: `winget install EclipseAdoptium.Temurin.25.JDK`
   - Mac / Linux: JDK 25 from adoptium.net
2. Download the zip from **ghidra-sre.org** (about 570 MB) and unzip it.
   - Mac: run `xattr -d com.apple.quarantine ghidra_*.zip` **before** unzipping (from Ghidra's own install notes).
3. Start `ghidraRun.bat` (Windows) or `./ghidraRun` (Mac / Linux). Challenge 15 has the next steps.

No Ghidra? dogbolt.org shows the same kind of code in your browser. Files must be under 2 MB, and dogbolt keeps what you upload.

Good luck, and have fun!